

ID2103 - Art & Aesthetics in Design

Syllabus

Unit 1: Foundations of Art, Aesthetics and Design Quality

Introduction to art and aesthetics. Definition of beauty, form and proportion. Elements and principles of design: line, shape, colour, texture, balance, rhythm, contrast and unity. The Design Quality Triangle and its three primary components, namely aesthetics, function and usability. How the three components are balanced against each other in a product, and how a change in one component affects the others. Examples from everyday consumer products such as furniture, mobile phones and televisions.

Unit 2: Art, Identity and Human Experience

Art as a medium of personal expression. How personal identity, memory, emotion and lived experience are communicated through painting, sculpture, photography, music and performance. Interpretation of an artwork by the viewer. Subjectivity of taste. Why certain artworks remain valued across generations while artistic trends change. Criteria used to judge artistic merit, originality and craftsmanship.

Unit 3: Art, Design and Society

Art as a mirror and as a transformative force in society. Art movements and social change. Design and culture, tradition and modernity. Public art, craft traditions and everyday objects. The role of art in questioning social norms, creating social awareness and shaping public opinion. Ethics and responsibility of the designer towards society and the environment.